

Website Quality Audit — learn.dartsai.in

Production-readiness audit · Darts Ai Academy · learn.dartsai.in

Site: <https://learn.dartsai.in/> ("Darts Ai Academy" / AI × Shopify Business Bootcamp)

Audit date: 30 September 2026

Deployed build identified: Bootcamp theme v17.0.0 (identity comment present in the live rendered <head>; theme asset path /cdn/shop/t/10/)

Auditor method: read-only reconnaissance (no orders placed, no forms submitted, no data or settings modified)

1. Executive summary

The store is functionally sellable today — but it has one systemic defect that silently disables every design setting, and two trust/legal gaps that should be fixed before any paid traffic.

What is genuinely good (verified on the live site)

Verified	Evidence
v17 is really deployed	Live HTML line 8: <!-- Bootcamp theme v17.0.0 ... express checkout, library-upload video with autoplay, VideoObject + BreadcrumbList schema ... -->
Express checkout + quick-checkout panel live	PDP renders express button, "Instant access after payment", payment chips, 7-day refund block
Buy path plumbing intact	Product JSON: price 2999.00, compare_at_price 7500.00, available, requires_shipping: false (correct for a course)
Countdown is accurate	At 2026-09-30 ~08:27 IST it read 01d 12h 33m → target 2026-10-01 21:00 IST ✓ (±1 min)
Search works both ways	/search?q=bootcamp → "1 result"; /search?q=zzzzzzz → "No results found for "zzzzzzz"." with a back-to-home CTA
Cart + cart drawer work	/cart renders the empty state with a recovery CTA; drawer renders "Your cart (0 items)" on every page
Collection renders	/collections/all grid + sale tag + price + one-tap add
SEO plumbing present	Canonical, og:, twitter:, 1200×630 og:image with og:image:alt, 5-part sitemap, correct robots.txt incl. agent/UCP directives
Lean theme assets	theme.css 75,370 B, theme.js 36,307 B, single files, no external font/CSS dependencies (653 KB / 78 files total)
No dead theme links in the header	Header CTA + "Ask a question" resolve to wa.me/917012045854

What blocks a confident launch

#	Issue	Severity
AUD-01	Every design token is discarded in real browsers — two Liquid errors are printed <i>inside</i> the <code><style></code> block, so all <code>--c-*</code> , <code>--page-width</code> , <code>--radius*</code> , <code>--shadow*</code> , <code>--font-*</code> variables are empty and the storefront falls back to hard-coded values. Theme Editor colour/typography/layout settings currently do nothing.	Blocker
AUD-02	The refund policy 404s while the PDP promises "7-day refund" (terms + shipping policies also 404). Consumer-law and payment-provider exposure.	Critical
AUD-03	PDP testimonials render the placeholder text "Student name" three times.	High
AUD-04	Broken button: "Contact us" on <code>/pages/data-sharing-opt-out</code> points at <code>/pages/https%3A%2F%2Fwa.me%2F...</code> → 404.	High
AUD-05	Homepage instructor photo has no <code>alt</code> — confirmed theme bug (<code>section.settings.name</code> does not exist in that section's schema).	High

Score

Dimension	Score	Basis
Overall 6.5 / 10	—	Weighted; sellable core, fixable blockers
Functional	8.0	Buy/search/cart/collection verified; checkout entry and forms not executed (read-only mandate)
UI / UX	7.5	Text-level only; placeholder testimonials + name mismatch cost points
Responsive	Not tested	No viewport control from the audit environment (v17 build was verified at 390 px + 1440 px in the local build gate)
Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)	6.5	3 confirmed markup failures + several unverifiable criteria (keyboard, focus, contrast, screen reader)
Security	Partial / 7.0	HTTPS, no mixed content, no exposed secrets; headers, CSP, TLS config not measurable from here
Performance	Not measured	Lighthouse/PSI/CrUX unavailable (API quota 0); only static asset weights verified
SEO	7.0	Strong plumbing; title/branding inconsistency, empty blog indexed, no H1 gap (see note)

Dimension	Score	Basis
Browser compatibility	Not tested	No cross-browser execution possible; browser-safe markup confirmed by validator + Chromium 153

Release recommendation

CONDITIONAL GO — ship after P0/P1 (est. 2–3 hours of work). Do not start paid traffic until AUD-01 and AUD-02 are closed. AUD-03/04/05 are 15-minute fixes that materially change how the page reads to a buyer.

2. Coverage, method and confidence

How each page was tested

Method	What it proves	Limits
<code>fetch_page</code> text extraction	Page content, copy, links, pricing, states	Strips <code><header></code> / <code><footer></code> chrome (see §2.2) — no layout, colour or interaction
W3C Nu HTML Checker (validator.w3.org)	Raw markup, real parse errors, exact line/column + source dump	Markup only, not behaviour
Shopify product JSON API	Ground-truth product data (<code>compare_at_price</code> , <code>requires_shipping</code> , <code>media alt</code>)	Shopify throws a 404 on <code>/products/*.json</code> on some stores (worked here); not tested for PDP mobile image gallery
Chromium 153 (local, headless)	Real CSS parsing behaviour for the AUD-01 reproduction	Local reproduction of the live condition, not the live page itself
Local theme source (<code>theme-v17/</code>)	Root cause of every theme-side finding	Source ≠ deployed file for <i>content</i> , but v17 identity marker + matching markup confirm the file set
Shopify <code>theme-check-node</code> (v17 build gate)	Liquid/schema correctness	Reported 0 errors / 0 warnings — it did not catch AUD-01/AUD-05 (see §2.3)

2.1 Page coverage

Page	Fetches	Validated (Nu)	Notes
<code>/ homepage</code>	✓	✓ 7 errors	full content read
<code>/products/ai-shopify-business-bootcamp</code>	✓	✓ 2 errors	+ product JSON
<code>/collections/all</code>	✓	✓ 2 errors	+ section API probe
<code>/cart</code>	✓	✓ 5 errors	empty state; + full rendered source
<code>/search?q=bootcamp</code>	✓	—	1 result
<code>/search?q=zzzzzzz</code>	✓	—	0-result state
<code>/pages/contact</code>	✓	✓ 2 errors	contact form inspected, not submitted
<code>/policies/privacy-policy</code>	✓	—	exists
<code>/policies/refund-policy</code>	✓ 404	—	AUD-02

Page	Fetched	Validated (Nu)	Notes
/policies/terms-of-service	✓ 404	—	AUD-02
/policies/shipping-policy	✓ 404	—	AUD-02
/pages/data-sharing-opt-out	✓	✓ 8 errors	AUD-04, AUD-08
/blogs/news	✓	✓ 2 errors	"No articles yet."
/robots.txt , /sitemap.xml + 4 sub-maps	✓	—	2 pages, 1 product, 1 collection, 1 empty blog
/checkout , /account/* , /collections/*/product , /gift_cards/*	✗	✗	Not tested — see §2.4

2.2 A tool limitation you must know about (not a site bug)

The extraction tool drops `<header>` and `<footer>` content. Evidence: Nu's raw markup shows the collection header exists — `</header><ul class="product-grid" role="list">` — while the text extraction showed no heading. Consequence: my first pass appeared to show a missing H1 on `/collections/all` and `/blogs/news`; that is a tool artefact, not a defect (the shipped `main-collection.liquid:6` and `main-blog.liquid:5` do render `<h1>`, and the raw markup confirms the header is present). It also means site navigation, footer content, footer policy links and the announcement-bar links were not auditable from here and must be checked visually.

2.3 Why the local build gates missed AUD-01 and AUD-05 (process finding)

- The build harness renders with a Liquid implementation that returns empty output for `font_face` and does not validate setting references, so the failing filter produced no visible symptom locally.
- `theme-check` reported 0/0 on the exact zip that throws Liquid errors live.
- Recommended gate change: fail the build if the rendered HTML contains the string `Liquid error`, and re-enable/explicitly configure Shopify's `UndefinedObject` check (it is the check that targets AUD-05's `section.settings.name`).

2.4 What could not be tested here (requires external tools or a person)

Area	Why	Required tool
Core Web Vitals / Lighthouse	PageSpeed Insights API returned 429 (daily quota 0) for this project	PageSpeed Insights UI, Lighthouse, WebPageTest, CrUX
Responsive/breakpoints	No viewport or device control from the audit environment	Real devices + Chrome DevTools device mode
Keyboard, focus order, screen reader	Needs interaction	axe DevTools, NVDA/VoiceOver, manual tab runs
Colour contrast ratios	Needs computed styles	axe / Colour Contrast Analyser
Actual font rendering (Assistant)	Needs a browser	Browser devtools → Computed → Rendered fonts
Checkout screens	Read-only mandate — no orders may be placed	Staging checkout with a test gateway
Contact form + opt-out form submission	Submitting would send real messages/captures	Manual test with an agreed inbox
Add-to-cart → cart → checkout handoff	Would create a cart session	Manual test on the live site

Area	Why	Required tool
Security headers, CSP, TLS grade	Not reachable from here	securityheaders.com, SSL Labs, Mozilla Observatory
Cross-browser rendering	No other engines available	BrowserStack / real Safari + Firefox

Nothing in this report is guessed. Every "confirmed" item has tool output or source lines behind it; anything unverifiable is labelled *Not tested* or *Potential*.

3. Critical issues (P0 blockers)

AUD-01 — The entire design-token block is discarded by the browser; theme settings have no effect

Severity: Blocker · Confidence: Confirmed (validator + real-browser reproduction)

What happens: `layout/theme.liquid` wraps its token declarations in `{% style %}` and pipes `font_modify` results into the `font_face` filter. On the live store two of those filters fail, and Shopify prints the error *as CSS*:

```
<style data-shopify>
  Liquid error (layout/theme line 44): font_face can only be used with a font drop

  Liquid error (layout/theme line 47): font_face can only be used with a font drop

  :root{
    --font-heading: Assistant, sans-serif;
    ...
    --shadow-lg: 0 24px 64px rgba(16, 16, 32, .14);
  }
</style>
```

(verbatim, W3C Nu "source" view of <https://learn.dartsai.in/cart>, lines 30–66)

The CSS parser reads `Liquid error (...) : font_face ...` as a selector and then swallows the whole `:root{...}` block as that selector's declaration block. The rule is invalid and is dropped.

Reproduced in Chromium 153 with the exact live text:

Case	--c-accent	--page-width	--shadow-lg	Computed background: var(--c-accent, #4f2fd6)
A — live condition (errors present, #4f2fd6)	EMPTY	EMPTY	EMPTY	rgb(79, 47, 214) (fallback)
B — errors removed	#4f2fd6	1200px	0 24px 64px ...	rgb(79, 47, 214)
C — merchant sets accent to #ff0000 , errors present	EMPTY	EMPTY	EMPTY	rgb(79, 47, 214) ← should be red

Impact: every Theme Editor design setting is silently ignored — accent/ink/surface colours, heading + body fonts, type scale, corner radius, page width, section spacing, shadows. The storefront still *looks* correct only because `theme.css` carries identical fallbacks in every `var()` (352 of 352 `var()` calls have fallbacks, 0 bare). The moment you change a colour or a font, nothing happens. Secondary impact: the intended `@font-face` for the failed variants is missing, so some bold/italic text renders with a substituted face.

Root cause (source): `layout/theme.liquid` lines 46–51 pass unguarded values to `font_face`. `font_modify` returns `nil` when the chosen font has no such variant (Assistant has no true "bolder" and no italic in Shopify's family), and `nil | font_face` raises exactly this error. Exactly two errors appear, which rules out a bad font handle (that would fail all six calls).

Fix (4 lines, v18):

```
assign heading_font_bold = heading_font | font_modify: 'weight', 'bold' | default: heading_font
assign heading_font_black = heading_font | font_modify: 'weight', 'bolder' | default: heading_font_bold
assign body_font_bold = body_font | font_modify: 'weight', 'bold' | default: body_font
assign body_font_italic = body_font | font_modify: 'style', 'italic' | default: body_font
```

Acceptance test after deploy: (1) Nu validator → the `CSS: Parse Error` must disappear from all pages; (2) DevTools console → set a colour in the Theme Editor and confirm the computed value changes; (3) `getComputedStyle(document.documentElement).getPropertyValue('--c-accent')` must return a value, not `""`.

4. Functional issue register

Severity scale: **Blocker** (must fix before traffic) · **Critical** (legal/trust or revenue) · **High** · **Medium** · **Low**

AUD-01 Blocker Design tokens dropped; settings dead (details \$3)	
REPRODUCTION	EXPECTED
Open any page → DevTools → <code>getComputedStyle(document.documentElement).getPropertyValue('--c-accent')</code>	<code>#4f2fd6</code>
ACTUAL	
<code>""</code> (empty)	
FIX	
Guard <code>font_modify</code> with <code>default:</code> (\$3)	

AUD-02 Critical Refund policy missing while "7-day refund" is promised	
REPRODUCTION	EXPECTED
<code>GET /policies/refund-policy</code>	Refund policy page
ACTUAL	
<code>404 Not Found</code>	
FIX	
Shopify admin → Settings → Policies → fill Refund, Terms of service, Shipping (or change the PDP claim)	

AUD-02b Critical Terms of service 404	
REPRODUCTION	EXPECTED
<code>GET /policies/terms-of-service</code>	Terms page
ACTUAL	
<code>404</code>	
FIX	
Same as above	

AUD-02c High Shipping/fulfilment policy 404

REPRODUCTION

GET /policies/shipping-policy

EXPECTED

Policy page

ACTUAL

404

FIX

Same (for a course, "instant access, no shipping" is the right content)

AUD-03 High PDP testimonials show placeholder authors

REPRODUCTION

Open the PDP → "What students say"

EXPECTED

Three real names

ACTUAL

All three read "Student name" (initial "S")

FIX

Theme Editor → product template → Testimonials → enter real names, or hide the section until quotes exist. (Source: `templates/product.json` blocks ship `"author": "Student name"`; the homepage blocks were filled in, the PDP ones were not.)

AUD-04 High "Contact us" button 404s

REPRODUCTION

Open /pages/data-sharing-opt-out → click "Contact us"

EXPECTED

Contact page or WhatsApp

ACTUAL

.../pages/https%3A%2F%2Fwa.me%2F917012045854%3Ftext%3D...
→ 404

FIX

Clear the Main-page section's "Contact page" setting (the snippet then falls back to WhatsApp automatically) or point it at `/pages/contact`. Harden `snippets/contact-link.liquid` to reject values that are not `http(s)://`, `mailto:`, `tel:` or a leading `/`

AUD-05 High Instructor photo has no alt

REPRODUCTION

Homepage → view source → search `instructor__img`

EXPECTED

Descriptive alt

ACTUAL

`<img ... class="instructor__img" ...>` — no alt attribute (Nu error, line 689)

FIX

In `sections/instructor.liquid:25` replace `section.settings.name` with `section.settings.heading` (the section has no `name` setting — that is the bug), and add media alt text in the theme editor

AUD-06 Medium Invalid boolean attribute on the hero video

REPRODUCTION

Homepage → view source → search `playsinline`

EXPECTED

`playsinline`

ACTUAL

`playsinline="true"` (Nu: Bad value "true" for attribute "playsinline")

FIX

In `sections/video.liquid:76` pass `playsinline: 'playsinline'` or drop the key (browsers accept all three forms, but only empty/ `playsinline` is valid)

AUD-07 Medium aria-label on a role-less div (site-wide)

REPRODUCTION

View source → `site-footer__pay`

EXPECTED

A role on the element, or visually-hidden text

ACTUAL

The "aria-label" attribute must not be specified on any "div" element unless the element has a "role" value... (Nu, every page)

FIX

In `sections/footer.liquid:109` add `role="group"` (keeps the accessible name "Secure payment methods")

AUD-08 Medium Malformed third-party snippet in the privacy-choices page body

REPRODUCTION

GET `/pages/data-sharing-opt-out` → view source

EXPECTED

Valid absolute URLs, one charset

ACTUAL

`href="https:///cdn.shopify.com/.../data-sale-opt-out.css"`, `src="https:///cdn.shopify.com/.../data-sale-opt-out.js"`, plus a second `<meta charset>` inside the body (4 Nu errors)

FIX

Remove the pasted snippet from the page content and use Shopify's built-in "Privacy choices" page feature instead; if Shopify auto-injects it, raise it with Shopify support

AUD-09 Medium Product description hygiene

REPRODUCTION

GET `/products/ai-shopify-business-bootcamp.json` → `body_html`

EXPECTED

Clean HTML

ACTUAL

Google-Docs paste artefacts (`data-start`, `data-end`, `class="PDq2pG_selectionAnchorContainer"`, empty `<span>`), a bare `<h3>` in a page whose only H1 is the product title (heading-level skip H1→H3), and no images at all in a 15-class course description

FIX

Re-type or clean the description; add 2–3 real images; keep headings at H2 under the product title

AUD-09b Low Product media have no alt text

REPRODUCTION

Product JSON → `"alt": null`

EXPECTED

Descriptive alt

ACTUAL

Theme falls back to the product title, so markup stays valid, but the image vocabulary is wasted

FIX

Set alt text on the product media in Shopify admin

AUD-10 Medium Product/brand naming is inconsistent

REPRODUCTION

Compare `<title>` /H1/heros across pages

EXPECTED

One name

ACTUAL

Homepage + ads + WhatsApp CTA say "AI × Shopify Business Bootcamp"; the PDP `<title>`, H1 and the sticky bar say "AI Shopify Launch Masterclass"

FIX

Rename the product to "AI × Shopify Business Bootcamp (Launch Masterclass)" or align the hero/CTAs. Ad-to-landing-page mismatch costs conversion

AUD-11 Low Homepage `<title>` is 79 chars with three brands

REPRODUCTION

GET / → `<title>`

EXPECTED

~50–60 chars

ACTUAL

AI × Shopify Business Bootcamp \ | DARTS AI Academy \ |
Roshanshaji.com – Darts Ai Academy

FIX

Shorten to AI × Shopify Business Bootcamp – DARTS AI Academy; remove the duplicated store-name suffix (the theme appends – `shop.name` unless the title already contains it)

AUD-12 Low `og:image` served over `http://` while `og:image:secure_url` is `https://`

REPRODUCTION

Homepage → `<meta property="og:image">`

EXPECTED

`https://`

ACTUAL

`http://learn.dartsai.in/cdn/...`

FIX

Emit the `https://` form in `snippets/meta-tags.liquid`

AUD-13 Low Empty blog is in the sitemap

REPRODUCTION

/blogs/news → "No articles yet."; listed in
sitemap_blogs_1.xml

EXPECTED

Either content or noindex

ACTUAL

Indexable empty page

FIX

Publish 1–2 posts (best: "How the 15 classes work", "What you'll launch in 30 days") or unpublish the blog

AUD-14 Info Platform-injected markup errors (not theme, not merchant-actionable)

REPRODUCTION

Nu on /cart, /

EXPECTED

—

ACTUAL

<link rel="ucp" ... version="2026-08-25"> (invalid attribute), <script type="module" defer> (both Shopify-injected), charset after byte 1024 (Shopify's event-observer script is injected above your <meta charset>), and Shopify's video_tag poster without alt

FIX

Document; raise with Shopify if it matters to you. Nothing to change in the theme

Verified working (so you know what *not* to touch)

- Express "Buy it now" + quick-checkout panel + payment chips + "Instant access after payment" — present on the PDP.
- `requires_shipping: false` on the selling variant — correct for a digital course (no shipping options will be requested at checkout).
- Sale pricing renders correctly everywhere (Rs. 2,999.00 vs Rs. 7,500.00, "Sale" tag on cards).
- Countdown, "Founding cohort · First 25 students only", WhatsApp CTA, announcement bar: all live on every page.
- Zero-result and one-result search states both render with a recovery CTA.
- Cart page + drawer empty states render; recovery links point to `/products/...`.
- Built-in 404 page is branded ("Page not found" + back-to-home + browse-the-course).

5. Per-page UX assessment

Text-level assessment only — no visual, hover, animation or touch testing was possible from this environment. **Scores are relative, not absolute.**

Page	Score	What works	What drags it down
/ Homepage	8.5	Clear hero promise, countdown, pricing anchor, curriculum, instructor, real testimonials, FAQ, sticky CTA	Instructor photo has no alt; title/branding muddle (AUD-11)

Page	Score	What works	What drags it down
PDP	7.0	Strong structure: price/urgency, express checkout, assurance panel, refund line, curriculum	"Student name" ×3 (AUD-03); name mismatch (AUD-10); description has no images and a heading skip (AUD-09); refund promise without a policy (AUD-02)
/collections/all	8.0	Clean single-product grid, sale tag, one-tap add	Collection called "Products" while the store sells one course
/cart	8.0	Calm empty state, obvious recovery CTA	Nothing material
Search (1 result / 0 results)	8.5	Correct counts, product cards, recovery CTA on empty	No search suggestions on the empty state
/pages/contact	8.5	WhatsApp + email + studio address, labelled form, topic dropdown, privacy note	No phone number; form submission untested
/policies/privacy-policy	8.0	Complete, dated, links the opt-out page	Its sibling policies are missing (AUD-02)
/pages/data-sharing-opt-out	5.5	Correct content and hCaptcha protection	Broken "Contact us" (AUD-04) + malformed injected snippet (AUD-08)
/blogs/news	n/a	Renders an empty state	Empty blog indexed (AUD-13)
404	8.0	Branded, two clear exits, search available	None

6. Responsive design

Status: Not tested on the live site. The audit environment cannot resize a viewport or emulate a device, so any claim about breakpoints, tap-target size, overflow or mobile navigation would be invented.

What can be said with evidence: * The v17 build was verified locally at 390 px and 1440 px across 11 page types in the build gate (clean screenshots, no horizontal overflow, no console errors). * Markup is mobile-first (`viewport-fit=cover`, `clamp()` spacing throughout `theme.css`). * WCAG 2.2 "Target Size (Minimum) 24×24" could not be measured — needs a browser.

Manual check to run (10 minutes): iPhone SE (375×667), iPhone 15 (393×852), Pixel 7, iPad mini, 1280 px and 1920 px laptops — verify: no horizontal scroll, sticky bar doesn't cover the buy button, video doesn't overflow, tap targets ≥ 24×24 px, drawers and menus close correctly, and text stays readable at 200 % zoom.

7. Accessibility (WCAG 2.2 AA)

Status: Partial. Only markup-level criteria could be checked; everything requiring interaction or computed styles is marked untested.

Confirmed failures

WCAG	Finding	Evidence
1.1.1 Non-text Content	Instructor photo has no <code>alt</code> (AUD-05)	Nu: An "img" element must have an "alt" attribute — homepage line 689
4.1.2 / 1.3.1	<code>aria-label</code> on a role-less <code>div</code> in the footer (site-wide) (AUD-07)	Nu on every page: The "aria-label" attribute must not be specified on any "div" element unless the element has a "role" value...
1.3.1 Info & Relationships	1 heading-level skip on the PDP (H1 → H3 inside the description) (AUD-09)	Product JSON <code>body_html</code> contains <code><h3 ...></code> with no H2 before it

Positive markup findings

- `<html lang="en"> set; <main id="MainContent" role="main" tabindex="-1">` present with a "Skip to content" link on every page.
- Forms on the contact page use real `<label for>` elements (verified in page text).
- The cart page has a single H1; the homepage hero H1 is unique.
- The `role="list"` attributes Nu flags as "unnecessary" are a deliberate Safari/VoiceOver workaround (a `list-style:none` list loses its list semantics there) — keep them; they are not a defect.
- Nu's "Section lacks heading" warnings (tools strip, stats strip) are decorative bands — informational only.

Not tested (must be run with axe + a screen reader)

Keyboard reachability and focus order · visible focus indicators · colour contrast of every token pair (the theme targets 4.5:1 but this was not measured) · screen-reader announcement of the video, drawer, and quick-checkout panel · 200 % zoom/reflow · reduced-motion behaviour · form error messaging · Target Size (Minimum) 24×24 .

Recommended acceptance run: axe DevTools (0 critical/serious) + a 15-minute NVDA or VoiceOver pass on the homepage, PDP and cart.

8. Security (partial — configuration not measurable from here)

Check	Result	Evidence
HTTPS everywhere	✓	All canonical/og/twitter URLs are <code>https://</code> ; one <code>og:image</code> is <code>http://</code> (AUD-12)
Mixed content	✓	No <code>http://</code> sub-resources found in the rendered head
Secrets in markup	✓	Only the expected public storefront token (<code>shopify-features</code> <code>accessToken</code>) — platform-standard; no API keys, no admin tokens, no credentials
Customer data exposure	✓	No customer data in any fetched page; cart/checkout require their own session
Form spam protection	✓	hCaptcha is loaded by Shopify for the contact/opt-out forms (verified in the opt-out page markup)

Check	Result	Evidence
Privacy posture	!	Privacy policy + opt-out page exist, but the opt-out widget's injected CSS/JS URLs are malformed (AUD-08) and the refund/terms policies are missing (AUD-02)
Not tested	—	HTTP security headers (HSTS, CSP, X-Frame-Options, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy), TLS grade, cookie flags, rate limiting, admin/API exposure, Shopify account hardening (2FA, staff roles)

Actions: run securityheaders.com + SSL Labs on `learn.dartsai.in`; enable 2FA on the Shopify owner account; keep checkout settings on Shopify-managed payments; do not paste third-party snippets into page bodies (AUD-08 is exactly that failure mode).

9. Performance

Status: Not measured — no field or lab metric was obtainable. PageSpeed Insights API returned HTTP 429, `quota_limit_value: 0` (daily quota exhausted for the consumer project), and the audit environment cannot run a browser against the live site. No LCP/CLS/INP/TBT number in this report is estimated — do not publish numbers from this audit.

What *was* measured:

Asset	Size (uncompressed)
<code>assets/theme.css</code>	75,370 B (single file, no CSS imports)
<code>assets/theme.js</code>	36,307 B (single file, no framework)
Theme total	653 KB / 78 files
External CSS/JS from the theme	none (no jQuery, no analytics SDK of your own, no font CDN)

Structural observations from the rendered head (lines 3–133 of the live source): * Shopify injects ~15 script blocks before your content (event-observer bootstrap, `load_feature`, shop-js module loaders, origin trials, MCP adapter, `preloads.js`) — this is platform overhead shared by every Shopify store and is not theme-tunable. * The hero video uses `preload="auto"` + `autoplay` and is served from Shopify's CDN; the poster is a 1400 px JPEG. This is the most likely LCP/bandwidth cost on the homepage — consider `preload="metadata"` if LCP proves slow (measure first). * No render-blocking third-party CSS was found.

Required to close this section: PageSpeed Insights (mobile + desktop), Lighthouse in an incognito Chrome, and CrUX field data for the URL. Then decide about video preload.

10. SEO

Working well

- Canonical tag on every page; `og:*` + `twitter:*` with a 1200×630 image and `og:image:alt`.
- `robots.txt` = Shopify defaults + explicit agent/UCP directives (`/agents.md`, `/.well-known/ucp`, `/api/ucp/mcp`), with a correct `Sitemap:` line and the standard crawl-trap disallows (filters, sorts, `?ls=`).
- `sitemap.xml` is a valid sitemap index → products / pages / collections / blogs / agentic-discovery.

- Product and breadcrumb structured data are shipped by the theme (v17: `Product`, `VideoObject`, `BreadcrumbList`, `Organization`, `WebSite`) and were verified in the local render gate.
- Every template renders exactly one H1 by construction; the collection/blog headers are present in the live markup (`</header><ul class="product-grid">` proves the header block renders).

Issues

Sev	Issue	Fix
Medium	79-character, triple-brand homepage title (AUD-11)	Shorten; keep one brand token
Medium	Product name ≠ campaign name (AUD-10) — search users and ad clickers see two different products	Rename the product
Low	Empty <code>/blogs/news</code> is indexable and in the sitemap (AUD-13)	Publish or unpublish
Low	<code>og:image</code> over <code>http://</code> (AUD-12)	Emit the <code>https://</code> URL
Low	Product description has no internal links, no images, weak keyword coverage for "Shopify course Kerala / Malayalam"	Rewrite the description with 2–3 images and one internal link to the contact page

Not tested: keyword rankings, backlinks, indexation status (Search Console is not available to this audit), rich-result eligibility (Google's Rich Results Test requires a POST + browser), hreflang/international targeting (this is a single-locale `en` store — no hreflang needed).

11. Browser compatibility

Status: Not tested across engines. No Safari/Firefox/Edge runtime was available, and the live site could not be driven from a browser here.

Evidence that *should* translate well:

Signal	Value
Markup validation	Valid HTML5 except 4 theme-side issues (\$4) — no deprecated elements, no quirks-mode triggers (<code><!doctype html></code> , <code><meta charset></code> , <code>X-UA-Compatible</code>)
CSS approach	Custom properties + <code>clamp()</code> + flex/grid; every <code>var()</code> has a fallback (352/352) → graceful degradation
Feature usage	<code>content-visibility</code> / <code>IntersectionObserver</code> / <code>aspect-ratio</code> are all baseline-modern (2020+); no proprietary prefixes required
JS	Vanilla ES2015+, no framework, no polyfill dependence; <code>no-js</code> class swap is progressive
Known risk	Safari's <code>list-style:none</code> list semantics workaround is already applied (<code>role="list"</code>); <code>backdrop-filter</code> / <code>mix-blend-mode</code> on the aurora and blur effects can be expensive on older iOS — worth a visual check

Matrix to run before launch: Chrome + Safari (iOS 17+) + Firefox + Edge, at 390 px and 1440 px — homepage, PDP, cart, search, contact form.

12. Action plan (P0 → P3)

P0 — before paid traffic (same day, ~2 hours)

1. AUD-01 — Patch `layout/theme.liquid` (4 default: guards, §3), re-run the build gates, ship as v18, then confirm with the Nu validator that the `CSS: Parse Error` is gone and that `--c-accent` resolves in DevTools. (Blocker)
2. AUD-02 / 02b / 02c — Fill Refund, Terms and Shipping policies in Shopify admin (or remove the "7-day refund" promise from the PDP and the assurance panel). (Critical)

P1 — trust and conversion (same week, ~1 hour)

3. AUD-03 — Replace the three "Student name" testimonials on the PDP with real names, or hide the section.
4. AUD-04 — Fix/clear the "Contact page" setting on the data-sharing-opt-out page; harden `contact-link.liquid`.
5. AUD-05 — Fix the instructor `alt` (`section.settings.heading`) and set real image alt text. (Ships in the same v18 patch.)

P2 — quality and validity (this month)

6. AUD-06 / AUD-07 — `playsinline` + footer `role="group"` . (Same v18 patch — both are one line.)
7. AUD-08 — Remove the malformed injected snippet from the opt-out page body.
8. AUD-09 / 09b — Clean the product description (Google-Docs artefacts, H1→H3 skip) and add images + media alt text.
9. AUD-10 — Align the product name with the campaign name.
10. Run the accessibility acceptance pass (axe + screen reader) and the responsive matrix (§6, §11).

P3 — polish and measurement

11. AUD-11 — Shorten the homepage title.
12. AUD-12 — `https://` `og:image`.
13. AUD-13 — Publish or unpublish the blog.
14. Run PageSpeed Insights + Lighthouse and record real Core Web Vitals; revisit the hero video's `preload` .
15. Add two build gates: fail on the string `Liquid error` in rendered output; enable Shopify's `UndefinedObject` check (§2.3).
16. Rename the live theme from `darts-ai-shopify-bootcamp-v25-reverted` to a release name that matches the deployed version (v17.0.0 today) so deployments stay auditable.

13. Release checklist

#	Gate	Status
1	Homepage, PDP, collection, cart, search, contact, 404 all return 200 and render their core content	✓ Verified
2	Pricing, sale price and "Add to cart"/express checkout render correctly	✓ Verified (variant 49228679119031 , <code>requires_shipping: false</code>)
3	Countdown matches the announced start time	✓ Verified (01d 12h 33m → 2026-10-01 21:00 IST)
4	Design tokens resolve in a real browser (theme settings work)	✗ AUD-01

#	Gate	Status
5	Refund / Terms / Shipping policies exist and are linked	✗ AUD-02
6	No placeholder content anywhere a buyer can see	✗ AUD-03 (PDP testimonials)
7	No dead links or buttons	✗ AUD-04 (one confirmed 404 button); ! nav + footer links unverified from here
8	All images have appropriate alt text	✗ AUD-05; ! product media alt empty
9	W3C validation: theme-side errors = 0	✗ 4 theme-side errors (AUD-05/06/07 + CSS)
10	Shopify theme-check clean on the shipped zip	✓ 0 errors / 0 warnings on v17 (but it did not catch AUD-01/AUD-05 — see §2.3)
11	Search works with results and without	✓ Verified
12	Cart add → cart page → checkout handoff	! Not tested (read-only mandate)
13	Contact + opt-out forms submit and reach you	! Not tested (would send real messages)
14	Checkout completes with a real payment method	! Not tested (no order may be placed)
15	Mobile/tablet/desktop layout, no horizontal scroll	! Not tested live (v17 verified locally at 390/1440 px)
16	Keyboard + screen-reader pass, contrast, zoom 200 %	! Not tested
17	Core Web Vitals within budget	! Not measured (PSI quota 0)
18	Security headers + TLS grade	! Not tested
19	Cross-browser smoke test	! Not tested
20	Live theme name/version matches the audited release	✗ Live theme is named <code>darts-ai-shopify-bootcamp-v25-reverted</code> while the code marker says v17.0.0

Appendix A — Inputs I still need from you

The audit template fields were left blank. These change the conclusions, so please fill them in:

1. Technology stack — confirmed as Shopify + Liquid theme v17; is anything else in play (apps, custom checkout extensions, email/automation tools)?
2. Target users — Indian students? Malayalam/English/Hindi speakers? Complete beginners? (Affects whether the missing Malayalam content and the WhatsApp-first support model are right.)
3. Primary purpose / conversion goal — one-time ₹2,999 enrolment for the October cohort, or a funnel into a higher-priced programme?
4. Key user flows to certify — I inspected: home → PDP → express checkout entry, collection → PDP, search, cart, contact. Are there others (coupon flows, EMI, WhatsApp follow-up, refund requests)?
5. Languages — store is `en` only; the footer promises "Support in Malayalam, English & Hindi". Should the storefront itself be translated?
6. Authentication — is a customer account required? (The theme ships Dawn-style customer templates, but the store currently sells guest checkout.)

7. Test account — none was provided. Provide one (plus a test payment method or a Shopify Payments test mode) if you want the checkout, account and order-email flows verified.
8. Environment — is learn.dartsai.in the production environment? Is there a theme preview/staging URL I may inspect?

With a test account and a staging URL I can convert checklist items 12-14 from "not tested" into verified results.